crownmoney.com.au SEO & AI Search Audit

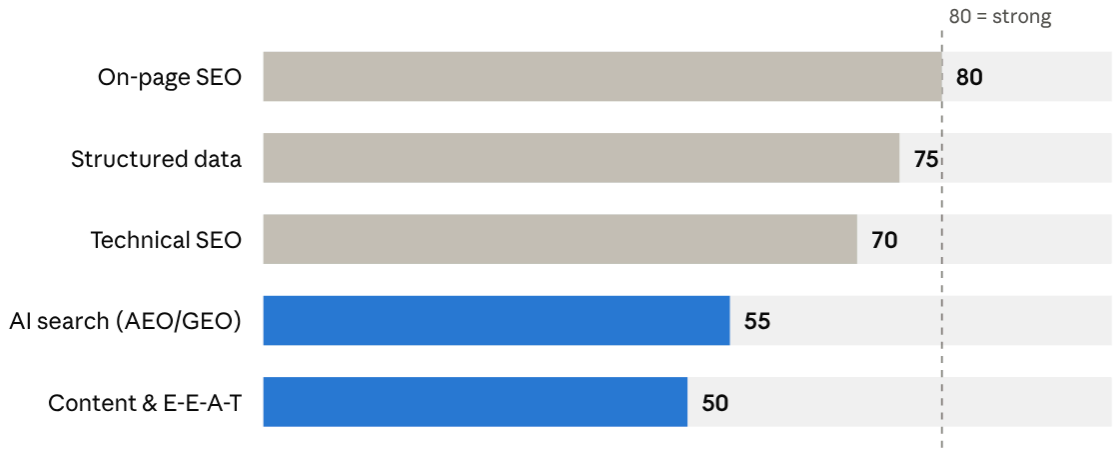
Nov 2, 2026 · @Che

Score: 65/100 — needs work

The site has a solid foundation (clean titles, schema on every page, llms.txt, licence details), but it is not "all good". Two site-wide technical issues and thin content are costing rankings and AI citations.

Content and AI search hold the score down

Overall score 65/100 (weighted) · dashed line = 80, a strong site



Weights: On-page SEO 20% · Structured data 10% · Technical SEO 25% · AI search (AEO/GEO) 20% · Content & E-E-A-T 25%

Audit of 22 pages on crownmoney.com.au, 2 Nov 2026

Verdict: fix the four issues below this week and the score should reach about 75; deeper guides and third-party reviews are what take it past 85.

Issues to fix first

Four issues hold the score down. None is hard to fix, and the first two affect every page.

#	Issue	Severity	Evidence	Fix
1	Every URL redirects to a trailing-slash version, but canonicals, the sitemap and all internal links point to the no-slash version	Critical	`/about` redirects to `/about/`; canonical on `/about/` says `/about`. Same on all 29 inner pages	Pick one form. Simplest: serve 200 at the no-slash URL (stop the redirect), or switch canonicals, sitemap and links to the slash form
2	Bots that don't run JavaScript sometimes get an empty app shell	Critical for AI search	An AI fetcher requesting `/about`, `/how-it-works`, `/tools`, `/reviews`, `/mortgage-reduction-calculator` and `/tools/debt-recycling` got a blank page titled "Crown Money | Pay Off Your Mortgage Faster" with no H1 or body. The slash versions served full content	Fixing #1 mostly solves this. Also make the Express server serve the prerendered HTML for both URL forms, never the SPA fallback
3	robots.txt served to bots differs from the one in your repo, and contradicts itself	High	Browsers get a clean allow-all file. AI fetchers got a Cloudflare-managed version that first **Disallows** GPTBot, ClaudeBot, Google-Extended, CCBot, Applebot-Extended, Amazonbot, Bytespider and meta-externalagent, then Allows several of them. That version's Sitemap line pointed to crown.money	In Cloudflare, review AI Crawl Control and the managed robots.txt setting. Decide per bot (see AI section), then make one consistent file

#	Issue	Severity	Evidence	Fix
4	Content is thin for a YMYL (money) topic	High	5 guides of roughly 450–650 words of prose; case studies around 150–250 words; stats (ABS, RBA, 3.7% savings rate) uncited; the payoff guide uses 6.25% in one section and 6.19% in the worked example	Expand guides to 1,500–2,500 words with cited sources, consistent figures, worked examples and tables

AI search (AEO / GEO) — 55/100

The site has the right AI-search building blocks (llms.txt, FAQ answers, licence details in schema), but mixed bot signals and empty shells stop AI assistants reading it reliably.

Check	Status	Details
llms.txt	Pass	Present at /llms.txt (4.7 KB) with legal name, ABN, ACL 388 279 and founder. /llms-full.txt is missing (404)
AI crawler access (robots.txt)	Fail	Bot-served file disallows then allows GPTBot, ClaudeBot, Google-Extended and CCBot. Each crawler resolves conflicts differently, so access is unpredictable
Retrieval bots listed	Warning	OAI-SearchBot, ChatGPT-User and PerplexityBot are allowed. Claude-SearchBot, Claude-User and Perplexity-User aren't named (they fall back to `*`, which is fine if the Cloudflare block doesn't catch them)
Cloudflare bot blocking	Warning	crown.money refused an AI fetcher outright (robots disallowed). Check AI Crawl Control isn't also blocking AI search bots on crownmoney.com.au
Content readable without JavaScript	Fail	See issue #2. Most AI crawlers don't execute JS, so an empty shell means no citation

Check	Status	Details
Answer-ready content	Warning	Homepage FAQ answers exist only in JSON-LD; the visible FAQ heading has no answers under it. AI engines and Google prefer answers visible on the page
Entity consistency	Warning	Brand is spread across crownmoney.com.au, crown.money (email + robots sitemap line) and crownmoneymanagement.com.au (302 redirect; Trustpilot profile still sits on this old domain)
Third-party citations	Warning	Few independent sources: a Trustpilot page, innovationsoftheworld.com and a Skool group. No comparison sites (Canstar, RateCity, Finder) or news coverage surfaced in search
Schema sameAs	Warning	Lists Facebook, LinkedIn, Instagram, YouTube. Missing Trustpilot, Google Business Profile and the MFAA/ASIC licence register
AI visibility tracking	Not checked	HubSpot AEO metrics returned a permissions error. Ask your HubSpot admin for AEO access to track ChatGPT, Gemini, Claude and Perplexity mentions

What to decide: "training" bots (GPTBot, ClaudeBot, Google-Extended, CCBot) learn from your content; "search" bots (OAI-SearchBot, Claude-SearchBot, PerplexityBot) fetch it live to cite you. Blocking training is a valid choice, but search bots must stay allowed if you want AI citations.

Technical SEO — 70/100

The basics are in place; the URL-form mismatch and uncached pages are the gaps.

Check	Status	Details
HTTPS	Pass	Served over HTTPS via Cloudflare
Unique titles & meta descriptions	Pass	All 22 pages tested have unique titles and descriptions in the server HTML

Check	Status	Details
Canonical tags	Fail	Present everywhere, but point to the no-slash URL that redirects (issue #1)
XML sitemap	Warning	30 URLs, all no-slash (redirecting). Every `lastmod` is today's date, so Google will likely ignore lastmod
robots.txt	Fail	Conflicting bot rules in the version served to crawlers (issue #3)
Prerendered HTML	Warning	Vite/React SPA with prerendered pages behind Express. Works for browsers; inconsistent for some bots (issue #2)
Server response	Warning	~630–780 ms per inner page; Cloudflare reports `cf-cache-status: DYNAMIC`, so HTML isn't edge-cached. Homepage ~340 ms
404 handling	Pass	Real 404 status with noindex. Minor: its canonical points to the homepage — remove it
Legacy domain	Warning	crownmoneymanagement.com.au uses a **302** (temporary) redirect. Change to 301 to pass link equity
Mobile viewport	Pass	`width=device-width, initial-scale=1` set
Images	Warning	Zero `<img>` elements on any page tested. Nothing for image search and no visual proof (charts, photos of clients/advisers)
Stray dev script	Low	`/_websocket-interceptor.js` loads on every page; looks like a build-tool leftover. Remove if unused
hreflang	Pass (n/a)	Single-language, single-region site; `lang="en"` set (could be `en-AU`)

On-page SEO — 80/100

Titles, descriptions and H1s are well written and keyword-led on every page; the issues are structure and depth.

Page	Issue	Severity	Fix
/ (homepage)	FAQ heading has no visible answers; answers only in schema	High	Render the 3 FAQ answers (and add 5–7 more) as visible text
/ (homepage)	JSON-LD block is output twice (identical FinancialService graph)	Medium	Remove the duplicate script tag
/ (homepage)	~475 words total including nav	Medium	Add a short "how it works" summary, fees range and adviser credentials
/guides/offset-account-vs-redraw-facility-australia	Title is 66 characters (cut off in Google)	Low	e.g. "Offset Account vs Redraw (Australia) | Crown Money"
/guides/* (all 5)	No H3s, no in-body links, no images or tables	Medium	Add H3 sub-steps, comparison tables, and 3–5 contextual links per guide to tools and case studies
/guides/how-to-pay-off-your-mortgage-faster-australia	Rate inconsistent (6.25% vs 6.19%); stats uncited	High	Use one rate; link ABS/RBA sources inline
/guides/*	dateModified auto-set to today on every build	Medium	Only change dateModified when content changes
/success-stories/* (6)	150–250 words of story each	Medium	Add timeline, before/after numbers table, client quote, and video embed from the testimonial library
/tools/* (calculators)	260–330 words; generic copy around the tool	Medium	Add "how to use", assumptions, worked example and FAQ under each calculator

Page	Issue	Severity	Fix
/reviews	No review content or rating summary in HTML	Medium	Embed real Trustpilot/Google reviews (self-serving review stars won't show in Google, but text helps AI and users)
All pages	`lang="en"`	Low	Set `en-AU`

Content & E-E-A-T — 50/100

Trust signals are strong (ACL, ABN, MFAA, named author and reviewer), but there are only 5 short guides. Competitors ranking for "pay off mortgage faster" (RateCity, CompareClub, Money Magazine, RACQ, peakifi.com) publish deeper, cited articles.

Strengths

- Author byline (Scott Parry) plus reviewer (Craig Parry, MFAA) on guides, with author pages
- Licence, ABN and address in schema and llms.txt
- A fees and methodology page, which builds trust with buyers and AI

Content gaps (highest priority first)

Topic	Format	Funnel stage	Priority	Effort
Is Crown Money legit? / Crown Money reviews	Reviews hub with real third-party reviews	Decision	High	Moderate
Crown Money vs mortgage broker vs doing it yourself	Comparison page	Consideration	High	Moderate
How offset accounts work (with calculator)	Guide + embedded tool	Awareness	High	Moderate
Extra repayments calculator / "how much faster with $X extra"	Calculator page	Awareness	High	Substantial
Mortgage stress: what to do when repayments rise	Guide	Awareness	High	Moderate

Topic	Format	Funnel stage	Priority	Effort
Refinancing vs restructuring your loan	Guide	Consideration	Medium	Moderate
Line of credit / mortgage offset strategies explained	Guide	Consideration	Medium	Moderate
Pay off mortgage in 10 years (realistic plan)	Pillar guide	Awareness	Medium	Substantial
Mortgage glossary (offset, redraw, LVR, comparison rate)	Glossary hub	Awareness	Medium	Moderate
Case studies by persona (single income, families, near retirement)	Hub pages	Decision	Medium	Quick win

Keyword opportunities

No SEO tool (Ahrefs/Semrush) is connected, so difficulty and opportunity are judged from the search results, not measured volumes. Current rankings are unknown.

Keyword	Difficulty	Opportunity	Intent	Content type
crown money reviews	Easy	High	Navigational	/reviews with real reviews
mortgage reduction program australia	Moderate	High	Commercial	Homepage / how-it-works
how to pay off mortgage faster australia	Hard	High	Informational	Existing pillar guide (expand)
mortgage reduction calculator	Moderate	High	Transactional	Existing calculator (add copy)
offset account vs redraw	Hard	High	Informational	Existing guide (expand)
extra repayments calculator australia	Hard	High	Transactional	New calculator

Keyword	Difficulty	Opportunity	Intent	Content type
debt recycling australia	Moderate	High	Informational	Existing guide + tool
how to budget with a mortgage	Moderate	Medium	Informational	Existing guide
is crown money legit	Easy	High	Navigational	FAQ + reviews
mortgage coaching australia	Easy	High	Commercial	New service page
pay off mortgage in 10 years	Moderate	Medium	Informational	New pillar guide
mortgage stress help	Moderate	Medium	Informational	New guide
how does an offset account work	Hard	Medium	Informational	New guide
rent vs buy calculator australia	Hard	Medium	Transactional	Existing tool
household budget calculator australia	Hard	Medium	Transactional	Existing tool
money coach australia	Moderate	Medium	Commercial	About / service page
how much interest will i save paying extra on mortgage	Moderate	Medium	Informational (question)	FAQ on calculator page
should i pay off mortgage or invest	Moderate	Medium	Informational (question)	Debt recycling guide section
refinance or restructure home loan	Moderate	Low	Consideration	New guide

Action plan

The quick wins below would move the score to roughly 75 within a week; the strategic work is what gets it past 85.

Quick wins (this week)

- [ ] Make URLs consistent: serve 200 on no-slash URLs (or move canonicals, sitemap and links to slash form) — impact high, ~1–2 hrs

- [ ] Make Express return the prerendered page for every URL form, never the SPA shell; test with `curl -A "GPTBot" https://crownmoney.com.au/about` — high, ~1 hr
- [ ] Cloudflare: review AI Crawl Control + managed robots.txt; keep search bots (OAI-SearchBot, Claude-SearchBot, PerplexityBot, ChatGPT-User, Claude-User) allowed; fix the Sitemap line — high, 30 min
- [ ] Show the homepage FAQ answers on the page; remove duplicate JSON-LD — medium, 1 hr
- [ ] Change crownmoneymanagement.com.au from 302 to 301 — medium, 15 min
- [ ] Stop auto-setting sitemap `lastmod` and article `dateModified` to the build date — medium, 30 min
- [ ] Turn on Cloudflare HTML caching for prerendered pages — medium, 30 min
- [ ] Fix 6.25% vs 6.19% in the payoff guide; shorten the offset guide title — low, 15 min
- [ ] Add Trustpilot, Google Business Profile and ASIC register to schema `sameAs`; set `lang="en-AU"` — low, 15 min

Strategic (this quarter)

- [ ] Expand the 5 guides to 1,500–2,500 words with cited ABS/RBA/ASIC sources, tables and images — high, multi-day
- [ ] Publish 8–10 new guides from the content-gap table, one topic cluster at a time (offset/redraw cluster first) — high, multi-week
- [ ] Move Trustpilot to the crownmoney.com.au domain and grow Google reviews — high for AI trust, ongoing
- [ ] Earn third-party mentions: comparison sites, finance podcasts, news commentary on rates — high for AI citations, ongoing
- [ ] Enrich case studies with numbers tables and the testimonial videos — medium, multi-day
- [ ] Get HubSpot AEO access and track 20–30 prompts (e.g. "best way to pay off mortgage faster Australia") monthly — medium, half day
- [ ] Connect Ahrefs/Semrush or Google Search Console to measure rankings and actual queries — medium, 1 hr

What's already good

- Every page tested has a unique, keyword-led title (41–66 chars) and meta description (140–161 chars)
- Exactly one H1 per page, logical H2s
- Structured data on every page: FinancialService, Article (with author and reviewer), HowTo, WebApplication, FAQPage, BreadcrumbList, ProfilePage

- llms.txt published, with full legal and licence details
- Real 404s, HTTPS, Cloudflare, mobile viewport
- Clean, readable URL slugs with target keywords

Method and limits

Tested 22 pages on 2 November 2026 by reading the raw HTML served from crownmoney.com.au in a browser, plus an AI web fetcher to see what non-JavaScript bots receive. Scores are weighted: technical 25%, on-page 20%, content 25%, structured data 10%, AI search 20%. Not covered: backlinks, real ranking positions and Core Web Vitals field data (no Ahrefs, Semrush or Search Console connected).

Sources

- crownmoney.com.au, sitemap.xml, robots.txt
- Crown Money on Trustpilot (old domain)
- Innovations of the World feature
- Competing results: RateCity, Money Magazine, RACQ, CompareClub, peakifi